

WHERE TO INVEST

Best & Cheapest Brokers in France

A no-nonsense comparison for PEA and CTO accounts

The wrapper matters (PEA vs CTO), but so does the broker sitting underneath it — order fees, custody charges, and account minimums quietly eat into returns over time. Here's who's currently cheapest and most reliable for each.

1 BEST PEA BROKERS

BROKER	ORDER FEE (EURONEXT)	OTHER FEES	BEST FOR
Trade Republic	€1 flat; €0 on scheduled/DCA plans	No custody, no inactivity fees	Simplicity + automated DCA
Bourse Direct	€0.99 flat (min order €80 on PEA)	No custody, no inactivity fees	Lowest all-in cost, French support
BoursoBank	€1.99 up to €500, then 0.60% (capped 0.50% by law)	Free custody; ~40 ETFs at €0 via BoursoMarket (min €200/ETF order)	All-in-one banking + investing
Fortuneo	Similar tiered pricing; 1st monthly order refunded on ~40 Amundi ETFs	No custody fees	Frequent small ETF orders
Saxo Bank	0.08%, min €3	No custody fees; periodic 0% promos on select PEA stocks	Broader European stock access
XTB	€0 up to €100k monthly volume, then 0.2%	No custody fees; auto IFU provided	High-volume, cost-conscious investors

Note: Interactive Brokers and DEGIRO do not offer a PEA wrapper — CTO only.

2 BEST CTO BROKERS

BROKER	ORDER FEE	OTHER FEES	BEST FOR
Trade Republic	€1 flat per order	No custody, no inactivity fees	Beginners, simple flat pricing
Interactive Brokers	~0.05%, min ~€1.25	\$3/month inactivity fee if under \$3 commission generated	Large portfolios (€50k+), global market access
DEGIRO	€1 + €1 handling (~€2 total per order)	No annual custody fee; FX conversion 0.25%; 1,000+ Core Selection ETFs at reduced/zero commission	Cheap international ETF investing
Bourse Direct	€0.99 flat	No custody, no inactivity fees	French investors wanting simplicity

Saxo Bank	0.08%, min €3	No custody fees	Active traders, broader instrument range
XTB	€0 up to €100k monthly volume, then 0.2%	No custody fees	High-volume investors

Note: DEGIRO and Interactive Brokers are CTO-only in France — no PEA, no automatic IFU from DEGIRO.

3 HOW TO CHOOSE

- **Beginner, simple monthly DCA:** Trade Republic or Bourse Direct.
- **Want banking + investing in one app:** BoursoBank or Fortuneo.
- **Large portfolio, global markets, lowest %:** Interactive Brokers.
- **Cheap international ETF access via CTO, no PEA needed:** DEGIRO.
- You can hold a PEA at one broker and a CTO at another — they don't need to be the same institution.

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No-fluff investing & money content for expats and international professionals in Europe.

Fees verified against broker fee schedules and comparison sites, July 2026. Broker pricing, PEA-PME availability, and promotions change frequently — always confirm current terms directly with the broker before opening an account. This guide is for general educational purposes only and is not personalized financial advice.